

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 3  
 ♥ A J 3 2  
 ♦ K 9 5  
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ J 10 9 6

♥ 8 5

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A K 8 3



♠ 8 5 2

♥ 10 7 4

♦ A Q 10 6 3

♣ Q 10

♠ A K 7 4

♥ K Q 9 6

♦ J 8

♣ 9 7 6

You have plenty good support to raise partner's ♣ suit. But your first priority is to show a 4-card Major suit if you have one. You do, so you respond 1 ♠. Partner raises you to 2 ♠.

Are you tempted to take partner back to ♣s since you have such good support? Don't be. Partner has 4 ♠s, but he might have only 3 ♣s.

Are you tempted to bid 3 ♠ since partner raised you? Don't be. He showed a minimum hand with his single raise and you only have 9 points. Just pass.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♣   |
| Pass         | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♠   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 2 ♠ by North |       |      |       |

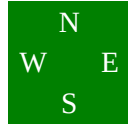
**Board 2**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5  
 ♥ 7  
 ♦ J 6 5  
 ♣ K Q 9 7 4

♠ A K 9  
 ♥ K Q 8 3  
 ♦ Q 10 4 2  
 ♣ 10 3



♠ 10 4 3 2  
 ♥ 10 5 4 2  
 ♦ 9 7  
 ♣ A 6 2

♠ 7 6  
 ♥ A J 9 6  
 ♦ A K 8 3  
 ♣ J 8 5

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1♦    | Pass | 1♥    |
| Pass        | 2♥    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South |       |      |       |

Some might jump to 2NT, "to show partner my point count". Some might jump to 3♦, "to force partner to game and show my ♦ support". The wise ones will just bid 1♥, striving to find an 8-card Major fit, the first priority of bidding.

You choose the 1♥ route, and partner obligingly says 2♥.

Remember "She who knows, goes"? You know of the 8-card Major fit. You know of at least 26 combined points. You know you should bid 4♥, so you do.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 4 2

♥ 5 4

♦ K Q 4 3

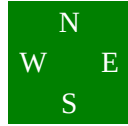
♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 9

♣ A J 10 7



♠ 8

♥ J 10 6 3 2

♦ A 8 5

♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ K Q 9 8

♦ 7 6 2

♣ K Q

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1♥. Partner replies 1♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

**Board 4**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 7 3  
 ♥ A 8 5 3  
 ♦ J 10 5  
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 4 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K 10 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

**Board 5**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 7 5 4  
 ♥ 9 7 4 3 2  
 ♦ J 3  
 ♣ A 6

♠ 10 8 3  
 ♥ K Q 10 6  
 ♦ A Q 6  
 ♣ Q J 5



♠ Q 6  
 ♥ A 8  
 ♦ 10 9 8 5 4  
 ♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A K 9 2  
 ♥ J 5  
 ♦ K 7 2  
 ♣ K 8 3 2

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1♥. Partner says 1♠.

Partner doesn't have 4♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1♣    |
| Pass         | 1♥    | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |